CIVILS ATLAS / RESEARCH EDITION 18

February 2026

Understand the news.
Retain what matters.

45 study notes · 30 MCQs · Mains frameworks

UPSC × Andhra Pradesh APPSC · English
Research cut-off: 7 November 2026

Read the coverage contract

Not exhaustive. Expanded monthly volumes are selected research batches; the rest of the requested archive remains incomplete. No month has passed a complete daily source audit. Full-text and source-extract evidence are distinguished. Historical notes do not certify current law, implementation or latest statistics.

New notes separate reported facts from original static connections, analysis, cautions and Mains prompts. P1 = core; P2 = consolidation; P3 = selective factual recall. Broad AP relevance is not exact APPSC paper mapping. Read the research audit for omissions and unresolved claims.

Daily discovery is NOT activated: GitHub repository deployment or first scheduled execution is pending. Automation collects unreviewed source links, not researched study notes.

Source extracts are not whole-document reviews. November covers only 1–7 November. Review research/Research-Status.md before treating any month as complete.

Subject guide

Polity & Governance — 5 notes

Economy — 12 notes

Agriculture — 1 notes

Society & Welfare — 4 notes

Environment — 3 notes

Science & Technology — 5 notes

Security — 3 notes

International Relations — 5 notes

Andhra Pradesh — 7 notes

How to study

Read P1 → consolidate P2 → recall P3. Review after 1, 7 and 30 days. Explain each caution unaided. Build answers with a dated fact, mechanism, limitation and conclusion.

Sources and access provenance appear in the appendix. Original analysis is not a sourced prediction of exam questions.

Polity & Governance

01 · Finance Commission devolution

XVI Finance Commission: 41% of divisible pool, not all receipts

E9-2602-009 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2026-02 · web posted: 2026-03-31 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The report/action-taken memorandum was tabled with the Budget. Magazine coverage month is an editorial index, not necessarily the event date.

• The award covers FY 2026–27 through FY 2030–31.

• The Centre accepts 41% vertical devolution of net proceeds of divisible Union taxes.

• Horizontal shares use multiple criteria, including GDP contribution.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Vertical allocation between Centre/states differs from horizontal allocation among states; cesses/surcharges are not automatically in the divisible pool.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• The memorandum records acceptance of devolution but separate treatment of other reform recommendations.

• A percentage of the pool is not the same as a percentage of gross tax collections or total Union revenue.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS APR25-006, E5-2506-003, E5-2508-010, E9-2602-030, VM2502-002, E5-2507-030, E5-2508-044, E5-2508-045 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not say every recommendation was automatically accepted or each state receives 41% individually.

MAINS PROMPT How can fiscal devolution preserve both equalisation and incentives for performance?

Sources: [E9-V02-05], [E9-FC]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

02 · Local-government grant conditions

Local-body grants: accounts, elections and timely state transfer

E9-2602-010 · P1 · 2026-02 (month-level index) · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The accepted memorandum specifies an accountability-linked framework.

• Total local-body grants are ₹7,91,493 crore over the award period.

• Basic/performance components are 80: 20, with additional urban components defined separately.

• Entry conditions include duly constituted bodies, published accounts and regular State Finance Commissions.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Intergovernmental grants do not substitute for constitutionally functioning elected bodies or local own-source revenue.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• States should transfer received grants within ten working days; delay attracts the specified interest rule.

• Do not equate the aggregate with cash already released, and do not impose the 80: 20 split indiscriminately on special components.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS VM2502-002, E5-2507-030, E5-2508-044, E5-2508-045, E7-2512-028, E7-2512-031, E7-2512-035, E8-2601-028 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Untied does not mean unrestricted: the memorandum restricts establishment spending and untied road expenditure.

MAINS PROMPT Can conditional local grants strengthen accountability without penalising weak-capacity communities?

Sources: [E9-FC]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

03 · Urban challenge finance

Urban Challenge Fund: competitive and market-linked assistance

E9-2602-023 · P1 · 2026-02 (month-level index) · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Cabinet approved central assistance of ₹1 lakhcrore.

• The reviewed project window is FY 2025–26 to FY 2030–31.

• Central assistance covers 25% of cost, with at least 50% market financing.

• Selection and releases are linked to reforms, milestones and outcomes.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A project grant, market borrowing and a repayment guarantee are different financing instruments.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Municipal capacity, credible cash flows and equitable service tariffs matter alongside leverage.

• Do not call the total a direct unconditional allocation to every city or assume each AP city is selected.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS VM2502-002, E5-2507-030, E5-2508-044, E5-2508-045, E7-2512-028, E7-2512-031, E7-2512-035, E8-2601-028 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Central assistance is not 100% project funding and approval is not proof bonds or loans were already raised.

MAINS PROMPT Can competitive urban finance improve services without excluding weaker municipalities?

Sources: [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

04 · Industrial-relations legal timeline

Industrial Relations amendment: repeal-date clarification

E9-2602-024 · P1 · 2026-02 (month-level index) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS Parliament passed the 2026 amending Bill.

• The Bill was introduced on 11 February.

• It clarifies repeal of the three replaced Acts from 21 November 2025.

• The underlying Code addresses unions, industrial disputes and other relations.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Passage of an amending Bill differs from proving assent, notification and implementation of every subordinate instrument.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Connect November 2025 commencement to February clarification rather than say the entire labour framework began only in February.

• Do not generalise this amendment to every provision of all four Labour Codes.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS E5-2507-009, E5-2507-010, E5-2508-028, E5-2507-020, E6-2509-023, E6-2510-027, E6-2510-033, E7-2511-023 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION A repeal clarification is not evidence every worker remedy disappeared or all compliance rules were already final.

MAINS PROMPT Why do transition and savings provisions matter in labour-law consolidation?

Sources: [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

05 · Rural decentralisation

Panchayats: schedules do not automatically devolve every function

E9-2602-030 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2026-02 · web posted: 2026-03-31 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The February magazine links rural spending with local institutions. Magazine coverage month is an editorial index, not necessarily the event date.

• PartIX and Article 243 G frame Panchayati Raj.

• The Eleventh Schedule lists 29 subjects.

• State legislation, staffing and fiscal assignments determine practical devolution.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL The three-tier panchayat rule is not a mandatory three-tier municipal hierarchy; the constitutional small-state exception also matters.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Follow functions with functionaries and funds, Gram Sabha scrutiny and district planning.

• Higher rural spending in nominal rupees does not alone prove empowered elected local governments.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS APR25-006, E5-2506-003, E5-2508-010, E9-2602-009, VM2501-001, E5-2507-013, E5-2507-014, E9-2602-017 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not reproduce a claim that identical three-tier structures are mandatory for both rural and urban local government.

MAINS PROMPT How can fiscal transfers strengthen genuine rural decentralisation?

Sources: [E9-V02-01]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

Economy

01 · Union Budget aggregates

Union Budget: estimates, deficits and comparison base

CA-002 · P1 · 2026-02-01 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Union Budget was presented on 1 February.

• Total FY 2026–27 expenditure is estimated at ₹53,47,315 crore.

• Receipts excluding borrowings are estimated at ₹36,51,547 crore.

• The fiscal deficit target is 4.3% of GDP, versus FY 2025–26 RE of 4.4%.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Budget Estimates, Revised Estimates and audited actuals describe different information stages.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• The 7.7% expenditure increase uses the previous year’s RE, not BE or actuals.

• These Budget-day ratios predate the 27 February GDP rebase; do not silently combine denominator vintages.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS FEB25-001, APR25-003, E5-2506-001, E5-2508-001, E5-2508-006, E6-2510-001, E6-2510-002, E7-2511-001 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION The target is not the realised deficit, and expenditure growth is not automatically inflation-adjusted.

MAINS PROMPT How should a Budget balance fiscal consolidation and productive expenditure?

Sources: [E9-PRS02], [B26]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

02 · GDP release vintage

GDP-2022–23 series: February second advance estimate

E9-2602-002 · P1 · 2026-02-27 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS MoSPI released the new national-accounts series on 27 February.

• The new base is FY 2022–23, replacing FY 2011–12.

• FY 2025–26 real GDP growth is estimated at 7.6%.

• New-series FY 2023–24/FY 2024–25 growth is 7.2%/7.1%.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A new base changes measurement/coverage as well as price reference; it differs from routine data revision.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• January’s 7.4% first advance estimate remains a correctly labelled earlier vintage, not an error to erase.

• The new 7.6% second advance estimate is still not a final FY 2025–26 outturn.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS FEB25-001, APR25-003, E5-2506-001, E5-2508-001, E5-2508-006, E6-2510-001, E6-2510-002, E7-2511-001 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not splice old/new-series growth figures as an unchanged-method time series or call all increases newly produced output.

MAINS PROMPT How can statistical rebasing improve credibility without creating misleading comparisons?

Sources: [E9-GDP], [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

03 · Deflation and quarterly benchmarking

GDP methods: double deflation and Denton benchmarking

E9-2602-003 · P1 · 2026-02 (month-level index) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The new-series release describes substantive estimation improvements.

• Agriculture and manufacturing adopt double deflation.

• Proportional Denton benchmarking replaces the previous pro-rata method.

• Unincorporated-sector surveys, GST and other administrative inputs improve coverage.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Double deflation treats output and intermediate inputs separately to estimate real value added.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• A lower measured nominal level can coexist with higher estimated real growth under a new framework.

• Better quarterly alignment is a method improvement, not proof every informal activity is now perfectly measured.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS FEB25-001, APR25-003, E5-2506-001, E5-2508-001, E5-2508-006, E6-2510-001, E6-2510-002, E7-2511-001 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not claim double deflation is used identically for all sectors or that methodology eliminates future revisions.

MAINS PROMPT Why do source coverage and deflation matter as much as the headline growth rate?

Sources: [E9-GDP]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

04 · CPI reference and publication

CPI 2024 launch: January data released on 12 February

E9-2602-004 · P1 · 2026-02-12 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The first release reports January 2026 inflation under the new base.

• The provisional combined year-on-year CPI rate is 2.75%.

• The corresponding provisional food inflation rate is 2.13%.

• The basket uses HCES 2023–24 weights and COICOP 2018 organisation.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Publication month differs from reference month; an index level differs from a percentage inflation rate.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• The 2.75% value is this release’s provisional vintage, not a guarantee later final figures are identical.

• Link January’s later-context supplement to this actual February release; do not place March’s February-data release here as February-known news.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS FEB25-001, APR25-003, E5-2506-001, E5-2508-001, E5-2508-006, E6-2510-001, E6-2510-002, E7-2511-001 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not compare an old-series December rate and new-series January rate as a pure unchanged-basket change.

MAINS PROMPT How should index revisions be communicated without losing continuity or public trust?

Sources: [E9-CPI], [E8-CPI]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

05 · Monetary-policy corridor

RBI February decision: repo held at 5.25%

E9-2602-005 · P1 · 2026-02-06 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The February 4–6 MPC retained the policy rate.

• Repo remains 5.25%.

• Standing Deposit Facility remains 5%.

• MSF and Bank Rate remain 5.5%; the stance remains neutral.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL SDF absorbs liquidity without collateral; repo and MSF provide liquidity through different facilities.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• An unchanged repo can coexist with changing liquidity conditions and lending-rate transmission.

• Neutral is not a promise that the next decision must be a cut or hold.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS FEB25-001, APR25-003, E5-2506-001, E5-2508-001, E5-2508-006, E6-2510-001, E6-2510-002, E7-2511-001 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not call this a fresh February 25-basis-point cut or infer every borrower’s EMI must change immediately.

MAINS PROMPT What determines transmission when policy rates remain unchanged?

Sources: [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

06 · MSME equity and liquidity

MSME package: growth equity differs from invoice finance

CA-041 · P1 · 2026-02-01 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget pairs equity, liquidity and professional support.

• A ₹10,000 crore SME Growth Fund is proposed.

• A scheme would revive 200 legacy industrial clusters.

• TReDS/GeM links, guarantees and corporate-mitra support are proposed.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Equity risk capital differs from discounting an accepted trade receivable and from a direct subsidy.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Separate this package from the ₹10,000 crore Startup Fund of Funds 2.0.

• For AP clusters, usable common services and timely buyer payment matter alongside fund size.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS E5-2507-009, E5-2507-010, E5-2508-028, E5-2507-020, E6-2509-023, E6-2510-027, E6-2510-033, E7-2511-023 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not count two distinct ₹10,000 crore funds as the same scheme or assume every MSME receives a guaranteed grant.

MAINS PROMPT How can MSME policy combine scale, working capital and compliance support?

Sources: [E9-BUD], [E9-PRS02], [B26]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

07 · Credit-risk instruments

Credit derivatives draft: CDS versus total-return swap

E9-2602-012 · P1 · 2026-02 (month-level index) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS RBI consulted on a revised corporate-bond derivatives framework.

• A CDS transfers specified credit-event risk for a premium.

• A total-return swap transfers coupon and price-change exposure under agreed payments.

• The draft addresses participants, reporting, prudential and customer safeguards.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A credit derivative can redistribute risk without eliminating it from the financial system.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Developing bond-market liquidity requires counterparty management and transparent exposures.

• A consultation is not proof every contemplated product is immediately available to every retail investor.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS FEB25-001, APR25-003, E5-2506-001, E5-2508-001, E5-2508-006, E6-2510-001, E6-2510-002, E7-2511-001 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not treat a CDS as a risk-free deposit or a TRS as ownership transfer in every case.

MAINS PROMPT How can credit derivatives deepen markets without obscuring leverage?

Sources: [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

08 · Property and infrastructure trusts

REIT/InvIT financing: consultation and existing rules differ

E9-2602-013 · P1 · 2026-02 (month-level index) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS RBI and SEBI issued separate consultation proposals.

• RBI proposes bank lending to eligible REITs with safeguards.

• SEBI consults on liquid-investment, SPV and borrowing-use changes.

• The InvIT greenfield proposal distinguishes public/private listed vehicles.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A REIT or InvIT owns cash-flow interests through structures; bank lending and investor-unit ownership have different risks.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Read consultation status despite summary passages saying “now permitted”; operative final directions need their own check.

• AP infrastructure funds are not automatically REITs/InvITs merely because they finance assets.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS FEB25-001, APR25-003, E5-2506-001, E5-2508-001, E5-2508-006, E6-2510-001, E6-2510-002, E7-2511-001 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not call every proposed relaxation a final rule or every trust a government-guaranteed investment.

MAINS PROMPT What prudential safeguards are needed as asset trusts gain financing flexibility?

Sources: [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

09 · Capital-market bank exposure

Bank CME directions: February issue, April commencement

E9-2602-014 · P1 · 2026-02 (month-level index) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS RBI amended capital-market exposure directions.

• The reviewed commencement date is 1 April 2026.

• They cover acquisition finance, lending against securities and intermediaries.

• The aggregate CME ceiling is 40% of eligible capital in the reviewed framework.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A ceiling on a bank’s exposure is not a guaranteed entitlement of each borrower or an LTV ratio.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Acquisition financing is conditional, with eligibility, leverage, valuation and security requirements.

• Maintain a February historical snapshot; verify later amendments before current compliance use.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS FEB25-001, APR25-003, E5-2506-001, E5-2508-001, E5-2508-006, E6-2510-001, E6-2510-002, E7-2511-001 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not present April commencement as already February operation or call 40% a universal loan-to-value limit.

MAINS PROMPT How should acquisition finance balance corporate growth and banking stability?

Sources: [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

10 · Startup capital architecture

Startup Fund of Funds 2.0: patient venture capital

E9-2602-017 · P1 · 2026-02 (month-level index) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Cabinet approved a ₹10,000 crore corpus.

- Focus areas include technology-intensive ventures needing long-term capital.
- Early-growth startups and smaller funds are targeted.
- Investment beyond major metros is an explicit objective.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A fund-of-funds mobilises capital through investment funds rather than guaranteeing an identical direct grant to every startup.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

- Track commitments, drawdowns and realised investee outcomes separately.
- Deep-tech eligibility does not prove a venture is commercially viable or free of technical risk.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS VM2501-001, E5-2507-013, E5-2507-014, E9-2602-018, E9-2602-030, E9-2602-031, E9-2602-033, E10-2603-021 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not confuse this corpus with the SME Growth Fund or the separate recognition turnover ceiling.

MAINS PROMPT How should public venture support address capital gaps without socialising every private loss?

Sources: [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

11 · Startup recognition thresholds

Recognition reform: ordinary and deep-tech criteria differ

E9-2602-018 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2026-02 · web posted: 2026-03-31 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The 5 February release revises eligibility. Magazine coverage month is an editorial index, not necessarily the event date.

• General recognition turnover threshold rises to ₹200 crore.

• Deep-tech eligibility extends to 20 years and ₹300 crore turnover.

• Specified cooperative societies become eligible subject to other criteria.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Recognition eligibility is distinct from automatic tax exemption, investment approval, loan sanction or grant receipt.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Research intensity and long gestation motivate deep-tech treatment; ordinary thresholds are not simply extended to all firms.

• AP cooperatives still need to satisfy the remaining innovation/business criteria.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS VM2504-004, MY25-020, E5-2507-026, E5-2507-020, E5-2507-032, E6-2510-029, CA-038, E9-2602-026 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not award 20 year/₹300 crore treatment to every enterprise or say cooperative registration alone guarantees startup recognition.

MAINS PROMPT How can recognition policy support innovation while preventing benefits from becoming untargeted?

Sources: [E9-V02-16], [E9-RECOG]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

12 · Textile programme design

Textile package: five linked components, not five completed missions

E9-2602-032 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2026-02 · web posted: 2026-03-31 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget proposes an integrated programme. Magazine coverage month is an editorial index, not necessarily the event date.

• Components include fibre self-reliance and traditional-cluster modernisation.

• Handloom/handicraft support and Tex-Eco sustainability feature.

• Samarth 2.0 is the skilling component.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Technical textiles are designed for functional performance, not only ordinary apparel; skilling differs from capital support.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Quality/testing, worker skills and environmental performance help exporters use negotiated market access.

• AP weaver measures are a separate state Budget proposal with its own eligibility/timing.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS MY25-002, CA-033, E5-2508-021, E5-2508-031, E6-2509-019, E6-2509-020, E6-2510-020, E6-2510-022 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not call proposed mega parks already operational or the SME Growth Fund exclusively a textile-only fund.

MAINS PROMPT How can textile policy link competitiveness, artisan livelihoods and sustainability?

Sources: [E9-V02-11], [E9-BUD]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

Agriculture

01 · Storage capacity and throughput

Grain storage: production is not a point-in-time stock

E9-2602-033 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2026-02 · web posted: 2026-03-31 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The magazine examines infrastructure and decentralised storage. Magazine coverage month is an editorial index, not necessarily the event date.

• FCI/state procurement and Central Pool storage have specific roles.

• PACS/local warehouses can support decentralised capacity.

• AIF, AMI and food-processing programmes have distinct objectives.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Annual production flows, seasonal stocks, warehouse capacity and throughput cannot be equated one-for-one.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Storage needs pest/moisture control, location, turnover and viable operations, not only announced tonnes.

• Do not call a proposed increase in a scheme’s credit target already disbursed lending.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS VM2501-001, E5-2507-013, E5-2507-014, E9-2602-017, E9-2602-018, E9-2602-030, E9-2602-031, E5-2507-015 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Central Pool storage capacity is not every private/household store or the entire national annual production requirement.

MAINS PROMPT How should decentralised storage improve farmer bargaining power without creating idle warehouses?

Sources: [E9-V02-12]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

Society & Welfare

01 · Mine and dock safety drafts

OSH consultations: risk plans and emergency readiness

E9-2602-025 · P1 · 2026-02 (month-level index) · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Draft regulations address metalliferous mines and docks.

• Mine proposals include safety-management and hazard plans.

• Emergency response/evacuation and protective systems feature.

• Dock proposals cover workplaces, equipment and emergency action.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Metalliferous mining is not the same scope as every coal mine; port safety rules do not substitute for navigation law.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• AP ports and mineral districts need contractor coordination, drills and enforceable reporting.

• Consultation deadlines are not proof final regulations commenced then.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS E5-2506-028, E5-2507-022, E5-2508-016, E5-2508-017, E5-2508-018, E6-2509-010, E6-2509-025, E6-2510-028 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not call drafts final law or a paper safety plan proof hazards are controlled.

MAINS PROMPT How should occupational safety connect management responsibility with frontline worker protection?

Sources: [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

02 · Road-trauma cashless care

PM RAHAT: ₹1.5 lakh and seven-day treatment limits

E9-2602-029 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2026-02 · web posted: 2026-03-31 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The 14 February release explains the national launch decision. Magazine coverage month is an editorial index, not necessarily the event date.

• Eligible victims on any category of road receive up to ₹1.5 lakh for up to seven days.

• The framework links eDAR with NHA’s TMS 2.0 and 112.

• Hospital reimbursement uses the Motor Vehicle Accident Fund.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Cashless treatment within limits differs from an unrestricted lump-sum cash compensation award.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Insured versus uninsured/hit-and-run cases have different funding channels.

• AP districts need designated-hospital readiness, timely authentication and grievance redress; do not equate portal integration with universal practical access.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS E5-2505-001, E5-2505-002, E5-2505-003, E5-2508-004, E6-2509-003, E6-2509-031, E6-2509-032, E7-2511-003 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not promise unlimited care at every hospital or confuse the police-authentication time with the entire maximum treatment period.

MAINS PROMPT How can road-trauma financing deliver timely treatment rather than merely reimburse bills?

Sources: [E9-V02-03], [E9-RAHAT], [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

03 · Women’s SHG livelihoods

Lakhpati Didi: sustainable household earnings, not automatic cash

E9-2602-031 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2026-02 · web posted: 2026-03-31 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The magazine discusses the mission’s progress and higher ambition. Magazine coverage month is an editorial index, not necessarily the event date.

• The initiative operates through SHGs under DAY-NRLM.

• The concept concerns sustained livelihood/household-income improvement.

• Credit, skills, enterprise development and market access are complementary inputs.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Household income, individual earnings, turnover and profit are different measures of empowerment.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Validate reported achievement with definitions, reference periods and sustained net incomes rather than treat all enrolment as success.

• AP SHGs need market demand, agency and protection against debt stress; a target is not verified achievement.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS VM2501-001, E5-2507-013, E5-2507-014, E9-2602-017, E9-2602-018, E9-2602-030, E9-2602-033, E5-2506-018 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not say every member receives an automatic ₹1 lakh grant or equate gross sales with disposable income.

MAINS PROMPT What makes SHG enterprise support translate into durable economic agency?

Sources: [E9-V02-10]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

04 · Dowry: retrospective legal context

Dowry enforcement: consent, presents and legal safeguards

E9-2602-038 · P2 · Magazine coverage: 2026-02 · web posted: 2026-03-31 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The February magazine revisits anti-dowry enforcement and an earlier case. Magazine coverage month is an editorial index, not necessarily the event date.

• The central statute is the Dowry Prohibition Act,1961.

• The legal concept concerns property/valuable security in connection with marriage, subject to statutory definitions/exceptions.

• Protection, investigation and procedural fairness remain distinct duties.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL All voluntary marriage presents are not automatically identical to a dowry demand; statutory conditions and evidence matter.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• The article names a 2025 case: do not invent a February 2026 judgment date; this is an editorial retrospective supplement.

• Avoid reproducing unsupported crime totals, automatic-arrest instructions or portraying extortion as a legitimate financial-security mechanism.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS E5-2502-002, E5-2507-034, E7-2512-029, E7-2512-032, E8-2601-011, E8-2601-012, E8-2601-037, E10-2603-043 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION A social practice’s prevalence does not make it lawful; complaint handling must protect survivors without dispensing with due process.

MAINS PROMPT How should law enforcement and social policy address dowry without reducing reform to arrests alone?

Sources: [E9-V02-32]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

Environment

01 · Disaster-finance shares

Disaster funds: distinguish total corpus from Union contribution

E9-2602-011 · P1 · 2026-02 (month-level index) · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Finance Commission memorandum specifies response/mitigation finance.

• State SDRF/SDMF combined corpus is ₹2,04,401 crore for 2026–31.

• Union share is ₹1,55,915.85 crore, distinct from the total.

• The SDRF: SDMF allocation is 80: 20.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Disaster response/relief and risk-reduction/mitigation are related but distinct expenditure purposes.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• AP planning should strengthen preparedness and eligible reporting alongside post-disaster spending.

• Do not add the whole joint corpus to local-body grants and call the result Union grants; it includes a state contribution.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS MY25-009, MY25-016, E5-2506-013, E5-2507-024, E5-2508-014, E5-2508-027, E6-2509-013, E6-2509-014 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION A multi-year allocation is not all disbursed in February, and national funds are separate from these state-fund totals.

MAINS PROMPT How should disaster finance rebalance relief, preparedness and mitigation?

Sources: [E9-FC]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

02 · Offshore mineral traceability

Offshore mineral rules: tracking, permits and monitoring

E9-2602-028 · P1 · 2026-02 (month-level index) · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Rules under the 2002 offshore-mineral Act were notified.

• The rules exclude mineral oils/hydrocarbons.

• Operating-right holders/carriers have electronic-monitoring duties.

• Dispatch/transit procedures require quantity, grade, route and payment records.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A maritime mineral operating right and permission for oil/gas extraction arise under different frameworks.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Dry-basis reconciliation and registered carriers support traceability but need independent checks.

• AP coastal application requires ecological/fisheries safeguards, not merely dispatch documentation.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS CA-013, JAN25-037, E5-2506-010, E5-2507-041, E5-2508-015, E6-2509-018, E6-2510-015, E7-2511-009 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not say all offshore extraction is automatically lawful from carrier registration or this rulebook covers petroleum.

MAINS PROMPT How can offshore-mineral governance combine traceability and ecosystem protection?

Sources: [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

03 · Carbon capture and net abatement

CCUS Budget proposal: ₹20,000 crore over five years

CA-040 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2026-02 · web posted: 2026-03-31 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget supports development/deployment in specified industrial sectors. Magazine coverage month is an editorial index, not necessarily the event date.

• Applications include power, steel, cement, refineries and chemicals.

• Capture, transport, utilisation and storage are different stages.

• The stated outlay is multi-year proposed support.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Point-source capture and direct-air capture have different feed streams; carbon use is not necessarily permanent storage.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Evaluate net lifecycle emissions, energy penalty, leakage and durable monitoring.

• CCUS complements efficiency, electrification and process changes; it is not the only decarbonisation option in every hard-to-abate sector.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS MY25-009, MY25-016, E5-2506-013, E5-2507-024, E5-2508-014, E5-2508-027, E6-2509-013, E6-2509-014 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not assume every captured tonne is permanently avoided or every utilisation route creates net negative emissions.

MAINS PROMPT Under what conditions can CCUS deliver credible industrial decarbonisation?

Sources: [E9-V02-29], [E9-BUD], [B26]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

Science & Technology

01 · Biopharma proposal

Biopharma SHAKTI: ecosystem support, not drug approval

CA-037 · P1 · 2026-02-01 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget proposes ₹10,000 crore over five years.

• The focus is domestic biologics and biosimilars.

• It proposes three new NIPERs and upgrading seven existing ones.

• It proposes over 1,000 accredited clinical-trial sites and stronger scientific review.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Biosimilars need comparability evaluation; they are not treated identically to every small-molecule generic.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• An ecosystem announcement does not establish every institute/site is operational or every product approved.

• Affordable access also depends on quality, competition, cold chains and procurement.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS E5-2507-009, E5-2507-010, E5-2508-028, E5-2507-020, E6-2509-023, E6-2510-027, E6-2510-033, E7-2511-023 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not call the entire five-year outlay one year’s actual expenditure or a blanket waiver of trial obligations.

MAINS PROMPT How can India expand biologics capacity while maintaining safety and affordability?

Sources: [E9-BUD], [E9-PRS02], [B26]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

02 · Semiconductor value chain

ISM 2.0: equipment, materials and Indian design capability

CA-038 · P1 · 2026-02-01 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget announces a next phase of the semiconductor mission.

• The stated focus includes equipment and materials.

• Full-stack Indian intellectual property and stronger supply chains feature.

• Industry-led research/training centres are proposed.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Chip design, equipment/materials, fabrication and packaging are different value-chain capabilities.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Use phased milestones, skills and supplier depth to judge capability creation.

• AP industrial opportunities require an identified implemented project; national ambition is not proof of a completed AP fab.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS VM2504-004, MY25-020, E5-2507-026, E5-2507-020, E5-2507-032, E6-2510-029, E9-2602-018, E9-2602-026 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not describe a mission announcement as immediate fabrication self-sufficiency or a specific commissioned factory.

MAINS PROMPT How should semiconductor policy measure durable capability beyond investment announcements?

Sources: [E9-BUD], [B26]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

03 · AI declaration versus law

AI Impact Summit: voluntary New Delhi Declaration

E9-2602-026 · P1 · 2026-02 (month-level index) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The summit concluded with an international cooperation declaration.

• PRS records 91 countries/international organisations endorsing the declaration at its reporting point.

• Themes include affordable AI resources and shared use cases.

• Scientific collaboration, skills and efficient systems feature.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Voluntary/non-binding international coordination differs from an enforceable global AI statute.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Endorsement counts are dated snapshots and may change; do not call 91 an immutable final total.

• Compute access needs data stewardship, skills and evaluation to yield public value.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS VM2504-004, MY25-020, E5-2507-026, E5-2507-020, E5-2507-032, E6-2510-029, CA-038, E9-2602-018 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not say every participant accepted a binding regulatory treaty or national safeguards became unnecessary.

MAINS PROMPT How can international AI cooperation improve access while preserving accountability?

Sources: [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

04 · Pax Silica and supply-chain security

India joins Pax Silica: chips need a wider ecosystem

E9-2602-027 · P1 · 2026-02 (month-level index) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS India joined on the AI summit’s sidelines.

• The coalition concerns secure silicon/critical-mineral supply chains.

• Semiconductors, advanced computing and related systems are the stated focus.

• The review distinguishes signatories from other participants.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A supply-chain coalition is not a military alliance by definition or a guarantee every export control is waived.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Diversify upstream materials, equipment and downstream capability; membership alone is not self-sufficiency.

• Do not equate observer/non-signatory participation with full signature.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS VM2504-004, MY25-020, E5-2507-026, E5-2507-020, E5-2507-032, E6-2510-029, CA-038, E9-2602-018 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Joining does not certify a new Indian fab is operating or unrestricted access to every advanced chip.

MAINS PROMPT How should India balance technological partnerships and strategic autonomy?

Sources: [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

05 · Gravitational-wave detection

LIGO-India: a construction contract is not an operating detector

E9-2602-036 · P2 · Magazine coverage: 2026-02 · web posted: 2026-03-31 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The magazine reports a facility-construction contract in Hingoli. Magazine coverage month is an editorial index, not necessarily the event date.

• The site is in Maharashtra, not Andhra Pradesh.

• Laser interferometry measures tiny relative arm-length changes.

• A geographically wider detector network improves source localisation.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Gravitational waves are spacetime disturbances, not ordinary electromagnetic light or sound needing air.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Civil works, optics, vacuum systems and commissioning are separate milestones.

• The contract report was not independently checked against the underlying tender/award in this pass.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS E5-2506-025, E5-2507-028, E5-2507-027, E5-2506-026, E5-2508-033, E8-2601-034, E8-2601-045, E9-2602-011 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not claim LIGO-India has already made observations or that the construction contract is the first gravitational-wave detection.

MAINS PROMPT What scientific value comes from geographic expansion of the gravitational-wave network?

Sources: [E9-V02-27]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

Security

01 · Defence procurement stages

DAC approvals: ₹3.6 lakhcrore is not equipment already delivered

E9-2602-019 · P1 · 2026-02 (month-level index) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Council cleared proposals across the services.

• The package includes Rafale/air-force capability proposals.

• Naval maritime-surveillance and power-generation proposals feature.

• Army approvals include platform overhaul and anti-tank capabilities.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Acquisition approval, contract signature, domestic production and delivery are distinct stages.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• A separate HAL Dornier contract must not be confused with approval for every platform in the aggregate.

• Assess life-cycle support, technology absorption and readiness beyond headline value.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS E5-2506-028, E5-2507-022, E5-2508-016, E5-2508-017, E5-2508-018, E6-2509-010, E6-2509-025, E6-2510-028 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not report the entire proposal value as February expenditure or all Rafales already manufactured domestically.

MAINS PROMPT How should defence procurement judge readiness alongside indigenisation?

Sources: [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

02 · PRAHAAR framework

PRAHAAR: counter-terrorism coordination and rule of law

E9-2602-034 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2026-02 · web posted: 2026-03-31 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The magazine reviews MHA’s policy/strategy. Magazine coverage month is an editorial index, not necessarily the event date.

• Its framework combines prevention, response and capacity building.

• Local police are first responders, with specialist support.

• Rights, international alignment and societal resilience are explicit dimensions.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A strategy guides coordination; it does not itself repeal criminal procedure or create unlimited surveillance powers.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Intelligence sharing needs lawful access, clear responsibility and follow-up, not just more data.

• Use risk-based community engagement without equating identity or dissent with violent extremism.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS E5-2502-001, E5-2507-029, E5-2507-021, E5-2508-007, E5-2508-012, E6-2509-011, E6-2509-012, E6-2510-013 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not treat an acronym as a new unlimited coercive statute or national agencies as automatically replacing local first response.

MAINS PROMPT How should counter-terrorism strategy combine prevention, resilience and constitutional legitimacy?

Sources: [E9-V02-23]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

03 · Border technology safeguards

Smart borders: sensors need resilient operating systems

E9-2602-035 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2026-02 · web posted: 2026-03-31 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The magazine discusses technology for difficult border terrain. Magazine coverage month is an editorial index, not necessarily the event date.

• Drones, tunnels and riverine/marsh terrain create distinct detection problems.

• Power, communications, maintenance and interoperable command are essential.

• AI/sensors can assist but do not replace trained assessment.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An author’s suggested oversight body differs from an officially established statutory authority.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Assess false alerts, cybersecurity and legal proportionality alongside coverage.

• AP maritime security needs coastal/community coordination; it is not the same deployment as a western land border.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS E5-2506-028, E5-2507-022, E5-2508-016, E5-2508-017, E5-2508-018, E6-2509-010, E6-2509-025, E6-2510-028 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not present the proposed Border Security Technology Oversight Authority as already created by government.

MAINS PROMPT How can border technology improve readiness without creating fragile or unaccountable surveillance?

Sources: [E9-V02-22]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

International Relations

01 · US framework and later legal shock

India–US trade: 7 February framework is not a timeless tariff table

E9-2602-015 · P1 · 2026-02-07 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The two countries announced an interim-agreement framework.

• The joint statement describes an 18% reciprocal rate on specified originating Indian goods.

• Some removals are conditional on successful conclusion and other findings.

• It expresses intended US purchases of$500 billion over five years.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Framework, final agreement, tariff legal authority and product-specific implementation are different stages.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• PRS records a later 20 February US Supreme Court ruling and further tariff action; the 7 February statement alone is not a month-end/current schedule.

• An intended purchase total is not a completed import bill or an unconditional government procurement contract.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS MY25-002, CA-033, E5-2508-021, E5-2508-031, E6-2509-019, E6-2509-020, E6-2510-020, E6-2510-022 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not say every Indian export permanently faced 18% after all later legal changes.

MAINS PROMPT How should trade policy manage negotiated access under legal and tariff uncertainty?

Sources: [E9-US], [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

02 · GCC negotiation mandate

India–GCC terms of reference: negotiating scope, not concluded FTA

E9-2602-016 · P1 · 2026-02 (month-level index) · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The parties signed terms to guide negotiations.

• GCC members are Bahrain, Kuwait, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia and the UAE.

• The terms set the scope/modalities for negotiations.

• Energy imports and engineering/agricultural exports shape the relationship.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Terms of reference differ from concluded negotiations, signature, ratification and entry into force.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Existing bilateral agreements with individual members have their own coverage/stage.

• AP exporters need product rules, logistics and sanitary compliance even if future tariffs fall.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS MY25-002, CA-033, E5-2508-021, E5-2508-031, E6-2509-019, E6-2509-020, E6-2510-020, E6-2510-022 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not describe the GCC as every West Asian country or all bilateral agreements replaced immediately.

MAINS PROMPT What are the opportunities and limits of a regional trade agreement with the GCC?

Sources: [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

03 · France partnership

India–France: elevated partnership and industrial cooperation

E9-2602-020 · P2 · 2026-02 (month-level index) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS President Macron visited India in February.

• The relationship was elevated to a Special Global Strategic Partnership.

• A foreign-ministers dialogue would review implementation.

• Defence, critical minerals and tax-agreement cooperation featured.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A strategic designation is political/institutional cooperation, not a mutual-defence treaty by definition.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Industrial joint ventures need executed production/certification milestones; announcements are not deliveries.

• Read the defence procurement note separately from bilateral-cooperation instruments.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS MY25-002, CA-033, E5-2508-021, E5-2508-031, E6-2509-019, E6-2509-020, E6-2510-020, E6-2510-022 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not treat every joint declaration of intent as an operational factory or guaranteed transfer of every technology.

MAINS PROMPT What converts a strategic partnership into durable technological capability?

Sources: [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

04 · Brazil resources and regulation

India–Brazil: minerals, digital and health cooperation

E9-2602-021 · P2 · 2026-02 (month-level index) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS President Lula visited India for bilateral talks.

- Agreed areas include rare-earth/critical-mineral cooperation.
- Drug/medical-device regulation and digital partnership feature.
- MSMEs, crafts and steel-supply-chain mining are included.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A cooperation agreement does not itself establish a producing mine or mutual recognition of every medicine.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

- Diversification needs sustainable extraction, processing capability and commercial contracts.
- Do not equate all rare-earth reserves with commercially available refined magnet inputs.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS MY25-002, CA-033, E5-2508-021, E5-2508-031, E6-2509-019, E6-2509-020, E6-2510-020, E6-2510-022 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION A bilateral document is not proof every intended resource shipment or regulatory approval occurred.

MAINS PROMPT How can South–South cooperation reduce mineral dependence without creating new concentration risks?

Sources: [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

05 · Malaysia technology and resilience

India–Malaysia: semiconductors, skills and disaster management

E9-2602-022 · P2 · 2026-02 (month-level index) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Prime Minister visited Malaysia for bilateral talks.

• Cooperation includes semiconductors and vocational training.

• Disaster management and health/medicine feature.

• Anti-corruption and security cooperation are also included.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Technology-ecosystem cooperation differs from locating a specific fabrication plant or automatic visa/employment rights.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Pair skills collaboration with recognised qualifications, industry demand and institutional continuity.

• Agreements need later implementation evidence rather than being counted as completed assets.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS MY25-002, CA-033, E5-2508-021, E5-2508-031, E6-2509-019, E6-2509-020, E6-2510-020, E6-2510-022 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not infer an unrestricted labour-mobility regime or a commissioned chip plant from a cooperation list.

MAINS PROMPT How should skills and technology partnerships reinforce economic resilience?

Sources: [E9-PRS02]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

Andhra Pradesh

01 · State Budget accounting perimeter

AP Budget 2026–27: total and net expenditure differ

CA-042 · P1 · 2026-02-14 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Finance Minister Payyavula Keshav presented it on 14 February.

• Total expenditure is about ₹3,32,205 crore.

• Debt repayment is about ₹22,147 crore.

• Expenditure excluding debt repayment is about ₹3,10,058 crore.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Loan-principal repayment is not counted in the same way as programme spending when comparing net expenditure.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• The roughly 11% total increase and 12% net increase use different accounting perimeters, not necessarily conflicting budgets.

• BE is authority/planning, not proof all allocations were spent or every announced benefit delivered.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS VM2502-002, E5-2507-030, E5-2508-044, E5-2508-045, E7-2512-028, E7-2512-031, E7-2512-035, E8-2601-028 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not subtract interest as if it were the same as principal repayment or label the entire headline developmental capex.

MAINS PROMPT How should AP present its Budget to make fiscal choices transparent?

Sources: [E9-APAFS], [E9-APPRS], [E9-APNEWS], [AP26]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

02 · Capital-expenditure reconciliation

AP capital headline: ₹48,698 crore outlay plus loans

E9-2602-040 · P1 · 2026-02-14 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Official AFS tables resolve differing news headlines.

• AFS capital outlay is about ₹48,697.71 crore.

• Loans and advances are about ₹5,217.67 crore.

• Together they are about ₹53,915.38 crore, excluding debt repayment.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Capital outlay, loans advanced and debt repaid are distinct capital-account transactions.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• The official statement is in lakhs: convert units before using newspaper crore values.

• A loan may finance public assets elsewhere but is not identical to direct state capital outlay; track repayments/asset quality too.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS VM2502-002, E5-2507-030, E5-2508-044, E5-2508-045, E7-2512-028, E7-2512-031, E7-2512-035, E8-2601-028 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not call ₹53,915 crore solely direct capital outlay or ₹48,698 crore the full broader capital-plus-loan total.

MAINS PROMPT Why does the composition of capital spending matter for AP’s growth and fiscal risk?

Sources: [E9-APAFS], [E9-APPRS], [E9-APNEWS]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

03 · Fiscal targets and revenue assumptions

AP deficits: planned improvement needs credible receipts

E9-2602-041 · P1 · 2026-02-14 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget targets lower deficits than FY 2025–26 RE.

• FY 2026–27 fiscal deficit is budgeted at about ₹75,868 crore,3.8% of GSDP.

• Revenue deficit is about ₹22,003 crore,1.1% of GSDP.

• Own-tax revenue is budgeted to rise 28% over the prior RE.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A revenue deficit differs from the fiscal deficit; a lower deficit ratio may reflect the denominator as well as fiscal flows.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Stamps/registration, excise and VAT assumptions need realisation checks after prior-year shortfalls.

• Compare borrowing ceilings with the eligible capex-loan exclusion; do not assume every borrowing is exempt.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS FEB25-001, APR25-003, E5-2506-001, E5-2508-001, E5-2508-006, E6-2510-001, E6-2510-002, E7-2511-001 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Budgeted revenue growth is not a realised increase or a certification of compliance with every borrowing condition.

MAINS PROMPT How realistic is deficit reduction when receipts depend on ambitious growth assumptions?

Sources: [E9-APPRS], [E9-APAFS]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

04 · Allocations versus entitlement

AP welfare/education: trace named schemes without double counting

E9-2602-042 · P1 · 2026-02-14 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget allocates funds across sector/department classifications.

• PRS records ₹27,719 crore for NTR Bharosa.

• Thalliki Vandanam is allocated ₹8,456 crore in the reviewed table.

• Health and Family Welfare sector allocation is about ₹19,630 crore.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A scheme allocation differs from an individual legal entitlement, beneficiary count or actual payment.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Broad welfare components and named departmental schemes may overlap; avoid mechanically adding all headline categories.

• Use current eligibility and payment records rather than infer universal benefits from an aggregate.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS E5-2506-018, E5-2508-029, E5-2508-030, E6-2509-027, E9-2602-031, E9-2602-043, E5-2505-001, E5-2505-002 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION NTR Bharosa social assistance is not identical to employee pension expenditure or the contributory APY scheme.

MAINS PROMPT How can AP assess welfare spending through access, adequacy and service outcomes?

Sources: [E9-APPRS]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

05 · Weaver electricity proposal

AP weaver power: April start and category-specific limits

E9-2602-043 · P1 · 2026-02-14 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The reviewed Budget policy announces support from 1 April 2026.

• Handloom weavers are proposed up to 200 units per month.

• Power-loom weavers are proposed up to 500 units per month.

• Category eligibility and implementation need operative state orders.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A monthly unit cap is not unlimited electricity or a cash payment of the same number of rupees.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Link February’s Budget announcement to the separate national textile package without merging funding mechanisms.

• Track metering, registration and fiscal/subsidy payment to ensure affordable supply does not create hidden arrears.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS E5-2506-018, E5-2508-029, E5-2508-030, E6-2509-027, E9-2602-031, E9-2602-042, E5-2507-009, E5-2507-010 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not say all state households receive these limits or the benefit began with February Budget presentation.

MAINS PROMPT How can targeted power support help weavers without weakening utility finances?

Sources: [E9-APPRS]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

06 · Wealth fund and contingent exposure

AP Wealth Fund: announced vehicle, not risk-free revenue

E9-2602-044 · P1 · 2026-02-14 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget proposes a state wealth-investment fund.

• A state investment vehicle manages financial assets under its mandate.

• The PRS analysis separately records about ₹1,77,328 crore outstanding guarantees as of 31 December 2025.

• A guarantee is a contingent exposure, not necessarily a called cash liability.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A wealth fund’s assets/returns, government debt and guaranteed enterprise liabilities must not be conflated.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Credible governance requires transparent funding, investment limits, valuation and public accountability.

• Do not present the fund as already generating a known return or older off-budget figures as February’s newly audited debt stock.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS VM2502-002, E5-2507-030, E5-2508-044, E5-2508-045, E7-2512-028, E7-2512-031, E7-2512-035, E8-2601-028 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION The word sovereign does not mean unlimited Union backing or immunity from market loss.

MAINS PROMPT What governance safeguards should underpin a state wealth fund with fiscal constraints?

Sources: [E9-APPRS]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

07 · Rare-earth corridor stages

AP named for proposed rare-earth corridors

CA-039 · P1 · 2026-02-01 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Union Budget names AP with three other mineral-rich states.

• The other named states are Odisha, Kerala and Tamil Nadu.

• The proposal links mining, processing, research and manufacturing.

• It follows the November 2025 rare-earth magnet scheme as a separate development.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A mineral resource, a separated oxide, metal/alloy and a finished magnet are different value-chain stages.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Environmental/radiological safeguards, processing economics and technology are essential; do not infer every deposit is immediately mineable.

• A Budget proposal does not identify a completed AP corridor or an operating local magnet factory.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS CA-013, JAN25-037, E5-2506-010, E5-2507-041, E5-2508-015, E6-2509-018, E6-2510-015, E7-2511-009 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not treat mineral abundance as automatic supply-chain self-sufficiency or call a proposed corridor already commissioned.

MAINS PROMPT How should AP build value-added mineral industries while protecting coastal environments?

Sources: [E9-BUD], [B26]

Evidence access: Actual access scope in source registry; static links, analysis and exam guidance are original

February 2026 recall laboratory

30 original questions, not previous-year questions. Answers follow all questions. Historical monthly snapshot only.

FEB26-01. A comparison says Union expenditure rose 7.7%. Which check is essential?

A. That the deficit target was already achieved.

B. That it measures 7.7% real growth by definition.

C. That the comparison uses FY 2025–26 Revised Estimates, not a different baseline.

D. That expenditure excludes every capital item.

FEB26-02. January’s old-series 7.4% and February’s new-series 7.6% estimates should be:

A. Spliced as identical-method final outcomes.

B. Treated as proof exactly 0.2% new output was physically created by rebasing.

C. Preserved with their different base years, estimate vintages and methodology.

D. Averaged to create an official estimate.

FEB26-03. Double deflation estimates real value added by:

A. Separately treating output and intermediate-input price changes.

B. Subtracting the same inflation rate twice from nominal GDP.

C. Using only consumer prices for every sector.

D. Eliminating every future statistical revision.

FEB26-04. On 12 February, the first CPI 2024 release’s 2.75% figure represented:

A. A guarantee of the eventual final January value.

B. February 2026 final inflation.

C. The absolute price-index level.

D. January 2026 provisional combined year-on-year inflation.

FEB26-05. Consider three statements about February’s decision: 1.Repo 5.25%.2.SDF 5%.3.Neutral stance guarantees the next move is a cut. Which are correct?

A. 1,2 and 3.

B. 2 and 3 only.

C. 1 and 3 only.

D. 1 and 2 only.

FEB26-06. A Budget proposes a biologics ecosystem and trial-site network. This alone establishes:

A. All trial sites are operational.

B. Every safety requirement is waived.

C. Every biological medicine is a simple generic equivalent.

D. Proposed capacity support, not automatic approval of every biosimilar.

FEB26-07. A state announces a semiconductor partnership after ISM 2.0. Which inference needs separate evidence?

A. That supply-chain depth matters.

B. That materials/equipment are distinct from chip design.

C. That a specific fabrication plant has been commissioned.

D. That training can complement investment.

FEB26-08. A small supplier discounts an accepted invoice on TReDS. This is principally:

A. The same transaction as a startup fund-of-funds commitment.

B. Receivables finance, distinct from an equity investment under a growth fund.

C. An equal unconditional grant to all MSMEs.

D. A completed purchase of a semiconductor fab.

FEB26-09. The accepted 41% vertical-devolution recommendation means:

A. Each state receives 41% of gross Union revenue.

B. All cesses automatically enter the pool.

C. Every other Commission recommendation is accepted without qualification.

D. The states collectively receive the specified share of net divisible Union tax proceeds.

FEB26-10. Consider: 1.Entry conditions include constituted bodies/accounts.2.States should pass grants within ten working days.3.Untied means salaries and all establishment spending are unrestricted. Which are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only.

B. 1 and 3 only.

C. 1,2 and 3.

D. 1 and 2 only.

FEB26-11. The ₹2,04,401 crore state disaster-fund corpus should not be described as:

A. Entirely a Union contribution, with no state financing component.

B. A corpus covering response and mitigation funds.

C. A multi-year allocation.

D. Distinct from national-level disaster funds.

FEB26-12. Which pairing is correct?

A. CDS—specified credit-event protection; TRS—transfer of total return exposure.

B. CDS—guaranteed full bond ownership; TRS—elimination of counterparty risk.

C. CDS—ordinary share ownership; TRS—cash reserve ratio.

D. CDS—risk-free deposit; TRS—automatic government grant.

FEB26-13. A February REIT lending consultation lists proposed eligibility rules. What is the safest interpretation?

A. Every REIT immediately acquired an unrestricted right to bank credit.

B. Check the final operative directions before treating every proposal as binding.

C. Every InvIT investment is government guaranteed.

D. A consultation deadline itself commissions an infrastructure asset.

FEB26-14. A 40% bank capital-market-exposure ceiling is:

A. A guaranteed 40% subsidy for every acquisition.

B. The same as a 40% repo rate.

C. Proof every bank can ignore borrower eligibility.

D. A prudential exposure limit, not a universal borrower loan-to-value entitlement.

FEB26-15. After the 7 February US framework and later legal events, which is justified?

A. Every export permanently faced exactly 18%.

B. Use a dated product/legal-authority check rather than assume 18% remained a universal permanent tariff.

C. Every conditional removal was completed on 7 February.

D. The$500 billion purchase intention was already fully spent.

FEB26-16. India–GCC terms of reference establish:

A. Automatic replacement of all bilateral agreements.

B. Immediate unrestricted tariff-free trade with every West Asian country.

C. Negotiating scope/modalities, not a concluded operative FTA.

D. GCC membership of every Asian economy.

FEB26-17. Two announcements each mention ₹10,000 crore. The Startup Fund of Funds 2.0 and SME Growth Fund are:

A. Turnover thresholds for ordinary startup recognition.

B. The same compulsory individual grant.

C. A single completed expenditure entry.

D. Distinct instruments whose corpus and delivery channels should not be merged.

FEB26-18. Consider: 1.General turnover threshold ₹200 crore.2.Deep-tech age/turnover thresholds 20 years/₹300 crore.3.Cooperatives qualify automatically without other conditions. Which are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only.

B. 1,2 and 3.

C. 2 and 3 only.

D. 1 and 3 only.

FEB26-19. DAC clears proposals with a large aggregate value. This is not equivalent to:

A. An acquisition-stage decision.

B. All contracts signed, equipment delivered and expenditure incurred.

C. A basis for later procurement scrutiny.

D. An opportunity to assess life-cycle support.

FEB26-20. A hypothetical eligible urban project costs ₹100 crore. Which financing package matches the reviewed headline conditions?

A. ₹25 crore central assistance and ₹75 crore mandatory grant from an unrelated state.

B. ₹25 crore central assistance and ₹10 crore market finance with no other qualifying market financing.

C. ₹100 crore central grant and no market finance.

D. ₹25 crore central assistance, ₹50 crore market finance and ₹25 crore local/state contribution.

FEB26-21. The Industrial Relations amendment should be read as:

A. A repeal-date clarification linked to November 2025, with passage distinguished from other legal stages.

B. Abolition of every worker remedy.

C. Proof all four Labour Codes first began in February 2026.

D. A substitute for every final subordinate rule.

FEB26-22. The New Delhi AI declaration’s reviewed character is:

A. Voluntary/non-binding international cooperation, not a global enforceable AI statute.

B. An exemption from all domestic data safeguards.

C. A universal mandatory treaty automatically displacing national law.

D. Proof exactly 91 will remain the endorsement count forever.

FEB26-23. The reviewed offshore-mineral rules cover:

A. Extraction without any operating right merely because a transit form exists.

B. Specified offshore minerals, excluding mineral oils/hydrocarbons.

C. All petroleum under an identical carrier permit.

D. Every unregistered vessel automatically.

FEB26-24. An eligible PM RAHAT case receives:

A. Unlimited care for seven years.

B. A requirement that all care always wait 48 hours before beginning.

C. ₹1.5 lakh cash regardless of treatment cost.

D. Cashless treatment within the ₹1.5 lakh/up-to-seven-day limits, not an unrestricted lump-sum award.

FEB26-25. Which statement correctly separates rural and urban institutions?

A. Every municipality must have the same three tiers as a panchayat.

B. Local elections are irrelevant to grant eligibility.

C. The three-tier panchayat structure should not be copied as an identical mandatory municipal hierarchy.

D. A schedule listing 29 subjects automatically devolves all staff/funds.

FEB26-26. To judge a Lakhpati Didi livelihood outcome, one should distinguish:

A. Sales revenue from profit as identical measures.

B. Sustained household income, individual control, turnover, profit and debt.

C. ₹1 lakh earned from an automatic ₹1 lakh state cash grant.

D. Every enrolment from guaranteed income success.

FEB26-27. Which comparison is conceptually sound?

A. Announced credit targets equal loans already disbursed.

B. Annual production must always equal central-pool storage capacity.

C. Every household store is counted in FCI capacity.

D. Warehouse capacity is a stock/space measure; annual production and throughput are flows.

FEB26-28. A magazine recommends a Border Security Technology Oversight Authority. What additional evidence is required to call it established?

A. Only the author’s recommendation.

B. A statement that sensors are useful.

C. An official constituting instrument or equivalent operative evidence.

D. A general discussion of drone threats.

FEB26-29. A carbon-capture project reports tonnes captured. To claim durable net abatement, it also needs:

A. Only the gross captured number.

B. Lifecycle energy/emissions accounting, transport/storage performance and leakage monitoring.

C. Assurance every utilisation route is permanent storage.

D. A declaration CCUS is always net-negative by definition.

FEB26-30. AP’s roughly ₹53,915 crore headline reconciles with the AFS as:

A. A figure entirely describing debt-principal repayment.

B. ₹53,915 crore direct capital outlay with loans additionally on top.

C. About ₹48,697.71 crore capital outlay plus ₹5,217.67 crore loans/advances.

D. Only ₹48,697.71 crore plus debt interest.

Explained answer key

FEB26-01. C Budget Estimates, Revised Estimates and audited actuals describe different information stages. The 7.7% expenditure increase uses the previous year's RE, not BE or actuals. Caution: The target is not the realised deficit, and expenditure growth is not automatically inflation-adjusted. [CA-002]

FEB26-02. C A new base changes measurement/coverage as well as price reference; it differs from routine data revision. January's 7.4% first advance estimate remains a correctly labelled earlier vintage, not an error to erase. Caution: Do not splice old/new-series growth figures as an unchanged-method time series or call all increases newly produced output. [E9-2602-002]

FEB26-03. A Double deflation treats output and intermediate inputs separately to estimate real value added. A lower measured nominal level can coexist with higher estimated real growth under a new framework. Caution: Do not claim double deflation is used identically for all sectors or that methodology eliminates future revisions. [E9-2602-003]

FEB26-04. D Publication month differs from reference month; an index level differs from a percentage inflation rate. The 2.75% value is this release's provisional vintage, not a guarantee later final figures are identical. Caution: Do not compare an old-series December rate and new-series January rate as a pure unchanged-basket change. [E9-2602-004]

FEB26-05. D SDF absorbs liquidity without collateral; repo and MSF provide liquidity through different facilities. An unchanged repo can coexist with changing liquidity conditions and lending-rate transmission. Caution: Do not call this a fresh February 25-basis-point cut or infer every borrower's EMI must change immediately. [E9-2602-005]

FEB26-06. D Biosimilars need comparability evaluation; they are not treated identically to every small-molecule generic. An ecosystem announcement does not establish every institute/site is operational or every product approved. Caution: Do not call the entire five-year outlay one year's actual expenditure or a blanket waiver of trial obligations. [CA-037]

FEB26-07. C Chip design, equipment/materials, fabrication and packaging are different value-chain capabilities. Use phased milestones, skills and supplier depth to judge capability creation. Caution: Do not describe a mission announcement as immediate fabrication self-sufficiency or a specific commissioned factory. [CA-038]

FEB26-08. B Equity risk capital differs from discounting an accepted trade receivable and from a direct subsidy. Separate this package from the ₹10,000 crore Startup Fund of Funds 2.0. Caution: Do not count two distinct ₹10,000 crore funds as the same scheme or assume every MSME receives a guaranteed grant. [CA-041]

FEB26-09. D Vertical allocation between Centre/states differs from horizontal allocation among states; cesses/surcharges are not automatically in the divisible pool. The memorandum records acceptance of devolution but separate treatment of other reform recommendations. Caution: Do not say every recommendation was automatically accepted or each state receives 41% individually. [E9-2602-009]

FEB26-10. D Intergovernmental grants do not substitute for constitutionally functioning elected bodies or local own-source revenue. States should transfer received grants within ten working days; delay attracts the specified interest rule. Caution: Untied does not mean unrestricted: the memorandum restricts establishment spending and untied road expenditure. [E9-2602-010]

FEB26-11. A Disaster response/relief and risk-reduction/mitigation are related but distinct expenditure purposes. AP planning should strengthen preparedness and eligible reporting alongside post-disaster spending. Caution: A multi-year allocation is not all disbursed in February, and national funds are separate from these state-fund totals. [E9-2602-011]

FEB26-12. A A credit derivative can redistribute risk without eliminating it from the financial system. Developing bond-market liquidity requires counterparty management and transparent exposures. Caution: Do not treat a CDS as a risk-free deposit or a TRS as ownership transfer in every case. [E9-2602-012]

FEB26-13. B A REIT or InvIT owns cash-flow interests through structures; bank lending and investor-unit ownership have different risks. Read consultation status despite summary passages saying “now permitted”; operative final directions need their own check. Caution: Do not call every proposed relaxation a final rule or every trust a government-guaranteed investment. [E9-2602-013]

FEB26-14. D A ceiling on a bank’s exposure is not a guaranteed entitlement of each borrower or an LTV ratio. Acquisition financing is conditional, with eligibility, leverage, valuation and security requirements. Caution: Do not present April commencement as already February operation or call 40% a universal loan-to-value limit. [E9-2602-014]

FEB26-15. B Framework, final agreement, tariff legal authority and product-specific implementation are different stages. PRS records a later 20 February US Supreme Court ruling and further tariff action; the 7 February statement alone is not a month-end/current schedule. Caution: Do not say every Indian export permanently faced 18% after all later legal changes. [E9-2602-015]

FEB26-16. C Terms of reference differ from concluded negotiations, signature, ratification and entry into force. Existing bilateral agreements with individual members have their own coverage/stage. Caution: Do not describe the GCC as every West Asian country or all bilateral agreements replaced immediately. [E9-2602-016]

FEB26-17. D A fund-of-funds mobilises capital through investment funds rather than guaranteeing an identical direct grant to every startup. Track commitments, drawdowns and realised investee outcomes separately. Caution: Do not confuse this corpus with the SME Growth Fund or the separate recognition turnover ceiling. [E9-2602-017]

FEB26-18. A Recognition eligibility is distinct from automatic tax exemption, investment approval, loan sanction or grant receipt. Research intensity and long gestation motivate deep-tech treatment; ordinary thresholds are not simply extended to all firms. Caution: Do not award 20 year/₹300 crore treatment to every enterprise or say cooperative registration alone guarantees startup recognition. [E9-2602-018]

FEB26-19. B Acquisition approval, contract signature, domestic production and delivery are distinct stages. A separate HAL Dornier contract must not be confused with approval for every platform in the aggregate. Caution: Do not report the entire proposal value as February expenditure or all Rafales already manufactured domestically. [E9-2602-019]

FEB26-20. D A project grant, market borrowing and a repayment guarantee are different financing instruments. Municipal capacity, credible cash flows and equitable service tariffs matter alongside leverage. Caution: Central assistance is not 100% project funding and approval is not proof bonds or loans were already raised. [E9-2602-023]

FEB26-21. A Passage of an amending Bill differs from proving assent, notification and implementation of every subordinate instrument. Connect November 2025 commencement to February clarification rather than say the entire labour framework began only in February. Caution: A repeal clarification is not evidence every worker remedy disappeared or all compliance rules were already final. [E9-2602-024]

FEB26-22. A Voluntary/non-binding international coordination differs from an enforceable global AI statute. Endorsement counts are dated snapshots and may change; do not call 91 an immutable final total. Caution: Do not say every participant accepted a binding regulatory treaty or national safeguards became unnecessary. [E9-2602-026]

FEB26-23. B A maritime mineral operating right and permission for oil/gas extraction arise under different frameworks. Dry-basis reconciliation and registered carriers support traceability but need independent checks. Caution: Do not say all offshore extraction is automatically lawful from carrier registration or this rulebook covers petroleum. [E9-2602-028]

FEB26-24. D Cashless treatment within limits differs from an unrestricted lump-sum cash compensation award. Insured versus uninsured/hit-and-run cases have different funding channels. Caution: Do not promise unlimited care at every hospital or confuse the police-authentication time with the entire maximum treatment period. [E9-2602-029]

FEB26-25. C The three-tier panchayat rule is not a mandatory three-tier municipal hierarchy; the constitutional small-state exception also matters. Follow functions with functionaries and funds, Gram Sabha scrutiny and district planning. Caution: Do not reproduce a claim that identical three-tier structures are mandatory for both rural and urban local government. [E9-2602-030]

FEB26-26. B Household income, individual earnings, turnover and profit are different measures of empowerment. Validate reported achievement with definitions, reference periods and sustained net incomes rather than treat all enrolment as success. Caution: Do not say every member receives an automatic ₹1 lakh grant or equate gross sales with disposable income. [E9-2602-031]

FEB26-27. D Annual production flows, seasonal stocks, warehouse capacity and throughput cannot be equated one-for-one. Storage needs pest/moisture control, location, turnover and viable operations, not only announced tonnes. Caution: Central Pool storage capacity is not every private/household store or the entire national annual production requirement. [E9-2602-033]

FEB26-28. C An author’s suggested oversight body differs from an officially established statutory authority. Assess false alerts, cybersecurity and legal proportionality alongside coverage. Caution: Do not present the proposed Border Security Technology Oversight Authority as already created by government. [E9-2602-035]

FEB26-29. B Point-source capture and direct-air capture have different feed streams; carbon use is not necessarily permanent storage. Evaluate net lifecycle emissions, energy penalty, leakage and durable monitoring. Caution: Do not assume every captured tonne is permanently avoided or every utilisation route creates net negative emissions. [CA-040]

FEB26-30. C Capital outlay, loans advanced and debt repaid are distinct capital-account transactions. The official statement is in lakhs: convert units before using newspaper crore values. Caution: Do not call ₹53,915 crore solely direct capital outlay or ₹48,698 crore the full broader capital-plus-loan total. [E9-2602-040]

Mains answer laboratory

Original answer-planning aids, not official model answers or exam predictions. Preserve dates, legal stages and data vintages.

Discuss fiscal consolidation and expenditure quality using the Union Budget 2026–27.

Study reference: CA-002

Dated anchor: The Union Budget was presented on 1 February.

1. Define BE/RE/actuals and the fiscal versus revenue deficit. Use the 4.3% fiscal target as a dated Budget-day estimate.

2. Argue that productive investment and effective services can reinforce medium-term revenue capacity.

3. Counterpoint: unspent allocations, optimistic receipts and weak project preparation can undermine both growth and consolidation.

4. Recommend realistic revenue scenarios, procurement readiness, milestone disclosure and independent outcome evaluation.

5. Do not recompute Budget-day ratios with the later GDP vintage without clearly labelling a new calculation.

Evidence caution: The target is not the realised deficit, and expenditure growth is not automatically inflation-adjusted.

Conclusion test: Name the implementing institution, identify a measurable outcome, and explain the financing or rights safeguard needed to sustain it.

Explain why national-accounts rebasing is more than changing a price index.

Study reference: E9-2602-002

Dated anchor: MoSPI released the new national-accounts series on 27 February.

1. Anchor the 27 February 2026 new 2022–23 series and 7.6% second advance estimate.

2. Explain updated coverage, multi-activity enterprise treatment, unincorporated surveys and administrative inputs.

3. Show why output/input deflation and quarterly benchmarking can change measured levels and growth.

4. Counterpoint: survey coverage, administrative-data quality and back-series gaps still constrain interpretation.

5. Recommend transparent bridge tables, methods, revision calendars and consistent-series comparisons; do not splice January’s old-series estimate without labels.

Evidence caution: Do not splice old/new-series growth figures as an unchanged-method time series or call all increases newly produced output.

Conclusion test: Name the implementing institution, identify a measurable outcome, and explain the financing or rights safeguard needed to sustain it.

Assess the Finance Commission’s role in equalisation and accountable local finance.

Study reference: E9-2602-009

Dated anchor: The report/action-taken memorandum was tabled with the Budget. Magazine coverage month is an editorial index, not necessarily the event date.

1. Distinguish vertical 41% divisible-pool allocation from horizontal state shares and grants.

2. Discuss equity, demographic performance, forest measures and contribution incentives without substituting gross revenue for net divisible taxes.

3. Use the primary memorandum to distinguish accepted devolution/local grants from recommendations only noted or awaiting examination.

4. Assess entry conditions: elected bodies, published accounts, SFC regularity; delayed transfer can weaken local service capacity.

5. Recommend capacity-building and timely transparent releases while retaining meaningful accountability.

Evidence caution: Do not say every recommendation was automatically accepted or each state receives 41% individually.

Conclusion test: Name the implementing institution, identify a measurable outcome, and explain the financing or rights safeguard needed to sustain it.

Can market-linked urban challenge funding improve municipal services?

Study reference: E9-2602-023

Dated anchor: The Cabinet approved central assistance of ₹1 lakhcrore.

1. Use the 25% central/at-least 50% market-financing design as an anchor, not an unconditional city entitlement.

2. Benefits: bankable preparation, performance incentives, integrated mobility/water/climate planning and greater financial discipline.

3. Risks: weaker ULBs lack credit capacity; tariff burdens, optimistic cash flows and guarantees may shift risk onto households/states.

4. For AP, build municipal accounts, credible revenue plans, service standards and independent appraisal before assuming project selection.

5. Recommend transparent competitive criteria, technical support and publication of outcomes/contingent exposure, not only funds leveraged.

Evidence caution: Central assistance is not 100% project funding and approval is not proof bonds or loans were already raised.

Conclusion test: Name the implementing institution, identify a measurable outcome, and explain the financing or rights safeguard needed to sustain it.

How can road-trauma financing close the gap between accident and effective treatment?

Study reference: E9-2602-029

Dated anchor: The 14 February release explains the national launch decision. Magazine coverage month is an editorial index, not necessarily the event date.

1. Start with PM RAHAT’s cashless ₹1.5 lakh/up-to-seven-day limits, not an unlimited compensation promise.

2. Map 112 response, ambulance routing, designated hospitals, police authentication and eDAR/TMS claims.

3. Benefits: lower upfront financial barriers and clearer hospital-payment channels.

4. Risks: delayed authentication, poor hospital readiness, refusal practices and weak grievance handling can frustrate the golden-hour objective.

5. For AP districts, evaluate arrival-to-treatment time, refusal rates, payment delays and patient outcomes; rapid access and accountable verification should work together.

Evidence caution: Do not promise unlimited care at every hospital or confuse the police-authentication time with the entire maximum treatment period.

Conclusion test: Name the implementing institution, identify a measurable outcome, and explain the financing or rights safeguard needed to sustain it.

Examine how counter-terrorism strategy can strengthen security and constitutional legitimacy.

Study reference: E9-2602-034

Dated anchor: The magazine reviews MHA’s policy/strategy. Magazine coverage month is an editorial index, not necessarily the event date.

1. Use PRAHAAR as a coordination strategy, not a replacement for criminal procedure.

2. Discuss intelligence-guided prevention, local first response, specialist support and whole-of-government capability.

3. Explain rights safeguards, proportionate lawful processes, community trust and resilience as operational assets.

4. Counterpoint: excessive data collection, identity profiling and fragmented responsibilities may undermine cooperation and credibility.

5. Recommend clear lawful information flows, auditability, training, independent complaint mechanisms and international cooperation focused on evidence.

Evidence caution: Do not treat an acronym as a new unlimited coercive statute or national agencies as automatically replacing local first response.

Conclusion test: Name the implementing institution, identify a measurable outcome, and explain the financing or rights safeguard needed to sustain it.

Why should Andhra Pradesh distinguish capital outlay, loans and repayment in growth planning?

Study reference: E9-2602-040

Dated anchor: Official AFS tables resolve differing news headlines.

1. Anchor official AFS values: ₹48,697.71 crore outlay plus ₹5,217.67 crore loans/advances equals roughly ₹53,915.38 crore.

2. Explain direct asset creation versus financial claims from lending; principal repayment changes debt but is not new programme expenditure.

3. Benefits: separate categories expose delivery readiness, borrower quality and future recoveries.

4. Counterpoint: classification alone cannot establish value; some revenue spending builds human capability and some capital projects underperform.

5. Recommend project appraisal, asset registers, loan-recovery tracking and consistent RE/BE/actual comparison; do not call the entire headline completed direct capex.

Evidence caution: Do not call ₹53,915 crore solely direct capital outlay or ₹48,698 crore the full broader capital-plus-loan total.

Conclusion test: Name the implementing institution, identify a measurable outcome, and explain the financing or rights safeguard needed to sustain it.

How can AP gain from rare-earth value chains while protecting coastal environments?

Study reference: CA-039

Dated anchor: The Union Budget names AP with three other mineral-rich states.

1. Distinguish Budget proposal, identified project, clearances, construction and actual output.

2. Map mineral resource, separation/refining, metals/alloys, magnet manufacturing and end-use demand.

3. Benefits: domestic supplier depth, skills and greater resilience rather than only raw-mineral exports.

4. Risks: processing economics, technology dependence, coastal livelihoods and mineral-specific environmental/radiological impacts.

5. Recommend transparent site appraisal, community engagement, credible safeguards, R&D/skills and milestone-based support; national naming is not proof a corridor is already operating.

Evidence caution: Do not treat mineral abundance as automatic supply-chain self-sufficiency or call a proposed corridor already commissioned.

Conclusion test: Name the implementing institution, identify a measurable outcome, and explain the financing or rights safeguard needed to sustain it.

Source register

Evidence access is recorded explicitly. Most non-PRS references were inspected as source extracts; primary full-text review remains open for them.

[B26] PIB · Union Budget 2026–27

https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2221455&reg=48&lang=2

Source check recorded in first edition; full-text access provenance not retained

[AP26] PRS · Andhra Pradesh Budget 2026–27

https://prsindia.org/budgets/states/andhra-pradesh-budget-analysis-2026-27

Source check recorded in first edition; full-text access provenance not retained

[E8-CPI] MoSPI · CPI 2024 series FAQs, February corroboration

https://www.mospi.gov.in/uploads/documents/documents/1770891066052-Annexure_V.pdf

Both chunks/all 7 pages of substantive FAQ text inspected; later February evidence for a January-coverage magazine supplement, not a January release

[E9-PRS02] PRS · February 2026 monthly policy review

https://prsindia.org/files/policy/policy_annual_policy_review/Monthly%20Policy%20Review/2026-02-01/MPR-Feb_2026.pdf

PDF chunks0–4 read, covering substantive review and opening references; final reference chunk not read. Main HTML fetch failed; guessed -1 route was a 404 and is not evidence.

[E9-BUD] Union Budget 2026–27 · Finance Minister speech

https://static.pib.gov.in/WriteReadData/specificdocs/documents/2026/feb/doc202621775901.pdf

PDF chunks0–1 of7 read: introduction and manufacturing/MSME/capex/CCUS/CER proposals. Later tax schedules and complete speech not independently read.

[E9-GDP] MoSPI · New GDP series press note, 27 February

https://static.pib.gov.in/WriteReadData/specificdocs/documents/2026/feb/doc20262227806501.pdf

Opening chunk0 of9 inspected: release date, methodological changes and growth highlights. Detailed later national-accounts tables/back-series documents not fully reviewed.

[E9-CPI] MoSPI/PIB · CPI2024 first release, 12 February

https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2227012&reg=3&lang=1

Chunk0 of11 read: introductory methodology, January provisional national figures, old-series December final figures and response notes. Later detailed tables/technical annexes not fully read; inherited FAQ access recorded separately.

[E9-FC] Finance Ministry · Action taken on XVI Finance Commission

https://www.indiabudget.gov.in/doc/16fc.pdf

Both text chunks/full explanatory memorandum read. Distinguishes accepted recommendations, in-principle acceptance, and items for later examination; not a full reading of both Commission report volumes.

[E9-US] PIB · United States–India joint statement, 7 February

https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2224783&reg=3&lang=1

Full substantive statement in chunk0 of2 read; conditional framework, not final current tariff schedule. Later US Supreme Court development follows PRS, not independently read judgment.

[E9-RECOG] PIB · Revised startup recognition, 5 February

https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2224069&reg=3&lang=1

Full substantive release in chunk0 of2 read: turnover/deep-tech criteria and cooperative inclusion. Gazette/recognition application rules not independently read.

[E9-RAHAT] PIB · PM RAHAT announcement, 14 February

https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2228172&reg=3&lang=1

Full substantive release in chunk0 of2 read, including limits, authentication, platforms, funding and grievance redressal. Not proof all designated hospitals already operational.

[E9-APPRS] PRS · Andhra Pradesh Budget Analysis 2026–27

https://prsindia.org/budgets/states/andhra-pradesh-budget-analysis-2026-27

Chunks0–2 of5 read: budget date, fiscal/expenditure/receipt tables, policy highlights, liabilities/guarantees and opening comparisons. Later annexure tail not fully reviewed; central GDP comparator is an earlier vintage and not reused as the newly rebased figure.

[E9-APAFS] Government of AP · Annual Financial Statement 2026–27

https://apfinance.gov.in/...Bud@et26-27/documents/Volume-I-1.pdf

Official page followed to PDF. Fetch chunk0 read, then targeted pymupdf extraction read PDF pages28,31,37,38,47,48 (printed26,29,35,36,45,46). Values in lakhs converted to crore; capital outlay and loans/advances reconciled. Not full detailed demands or all statement pages.

[E9-APNEWS] The New Indian Express · AP Budget, 15 February

https://www.newindianexpress.com/states/andhra-pradesh/2026/Feb/15/ap-tables-rs-332-lakh-crore-budget-for-202627-sharp-push-on-capital-spend-wealth-creation

Substantive contemporary search extract inspected, not full article. ₹53,915crore headline reconciled with official AFS capital outlay plus loans/advances; not a primary project-completion source.

[E9-V02-05] Vision IAS · 2026-02 · recommendations of 16th finance commission

https://visionias.in/current-affairs/monthly-magazine/2026-03-31/polity-and-governance/recommendations-of-16th-finance-commission

Selected lead/substantive passages inspected, not complete issue/article or primary-text review

[E9-V02-16] Vision IAS · 2026-02 · startup recognition framework

https://visionias.in/current-affairs/monthly-magazine/2026-03-31/economy/startup-recognition-framework

Selected lead/substantive passages inspected, not complete issue/article or primary-text review

[E9-V02-03] Vision IAS · 2026-02 · pm rahat road accident victim hospitalization and assured treatment

https://visionias.in/current-affairs/monthly-magazine/2026-03-31/polity-and-governance/pm-rahat-road-accident-victim-hospitalization-and-assured-treatment

Selected lead/substantive passages inspected, not complete issue/article or primary-text review

[E9-V02-01] Vision IAS · 2026-02 · rural transformation through decentralization

https://visionias.in/current-affairs/monthly-magazine/2026-03-31/polity-and-governance/rural-transformation-through-decentralization

Selected lead/substantive passages inspected, not complete issue/article or primary-text review

[E9-V02-10] Vision IAS · 2026-02 · lakhpati didi

https://visionias.in/current-affairs/monthly-magazine/2026-03-31/economy/lakhpati-didi

Selected lead/substantive passages inspected, not complete issue/article or primary-text review

[E9-V02-11] Vision IAS · 2026-02 · textile sector in india

https://visionias.in/current-affairs/monthly-magazine/2026-03-31/economy/textile-sector-in-india

Selected lead/substantive passages inspected, not complete issue/article or primary-text review

[E9-V02-12] Vision IAS · 2026-02 · grain storage systems in india

https://visionias.in/current-affairs/monthly-magazine/2026-03-31/economy/grain-storage-systems-in-india

Selected lead/substantive passages inspected, not complete issue/article or primary-text review

[E9-V02-23] Vision IAS · 2026-02 · prahaar national counter terrorism policy strategy

https://visionias.in/current-affairs/monthly-magazine/2026-03-31/security/prahaar-national-counter-terrorism-policy-strategy

Selected lead/substantive passages inspected, not complete issue/article or primary-text review

[E9-V02-22] Vision IAS · 2026-02 · advance technology border management

https://visionias.in/current-affairs/monthly-magazine/2026-03-31/security/advance-technology-border-management

Selected lead/substantive passages inspected, not complete issue/article or primary-text review

[E9-V02-27] Vision IAS · 2026-02 · laser interferometer gravitational wave observatory ligo

https://visionias.in/current-affairs/monthly-magazine/2026-03-31/science-and-technology/laser-interferometer-gravitational-wave-observatory-ligo

Selected lead/substantive passages inspected, not complete issue/article or primary-text review

[E9-V02-29] Vision IAS · 2026-02 · carbon capture utilisation and storage ccus

https://visionias.in/current-affairs/monthly-magazine/2026-03-31/environment/carbon-capture-utilisation-and-storage-ccus

Selected lead/substantive passages inspected, not complete issue/article or primary-text review

[E9-V02-32] Vision IAS · 2026-02 · dowry in india

https://visionias.in/current-affairs/monthly-magazine/2026-03-31/society/dowry-in-india

Selected lead/substantive passages inspected, not complete issue/article or primary-text review

Unfinished research

Not exhaustive. Expanded monthly volumes are selected research batches; the rest of the requested archive remains incomplete. No month has passed a complete daily source audit. Full-text and source-extract evidence are distinguished. Historical notes do not certify current law, implementation or latest statistics.

Daily-source reconciliation remains open for every month. Further periods remain unfinished. The monthly inventory and daily/monthly ledgers record work required, not additional completed coverage.

The automation files collect links only after deployment and enabling. No hidden researcher will fill the remaining months after this response.

Read research/Research-Status.md for corrections, exclusions, evidence caveats and close-out tasks.